



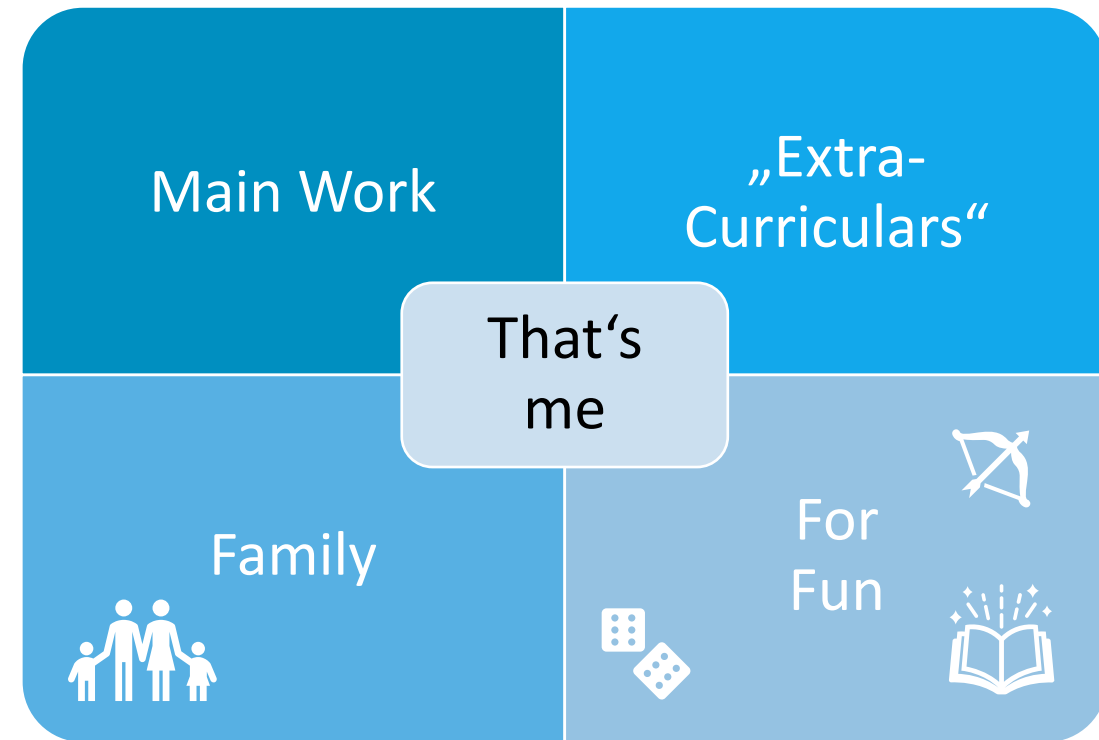
Change Management 4 Basic Service Teams

Base4NFDI Service Jour Fix - 13.5.2026

Based on: Manske, A., & Zänkert, S. (2024, November 26).
Agents of Change - Skills & Strategies for RDM Professionals.
<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14221846>

Antje Manske

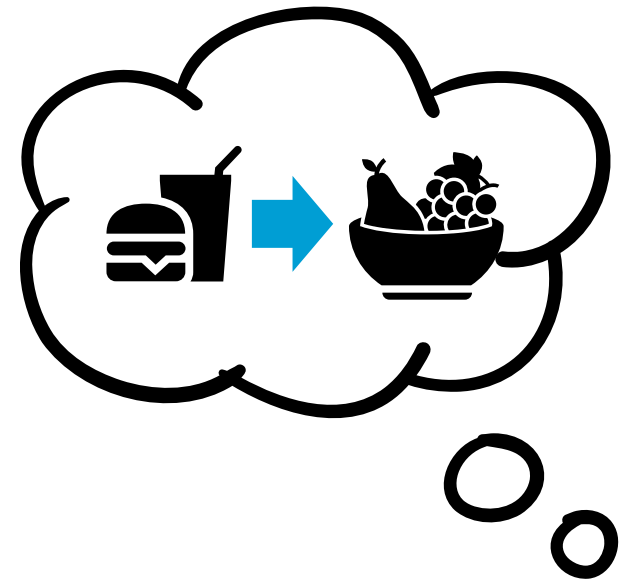
- Training Manager @ Base4NFDI (since 2023) and professional freelancer
- Enthusiast for learning and infinitely curious about human behavior
- Dipl. Päd. aka professional in behaviour change and learning
- ~ 12 years in management consulting
- Certified Prosci Change Practitioner & Certified Professional in Talent Development (ATD)



Changing peoples behaviors is not easy

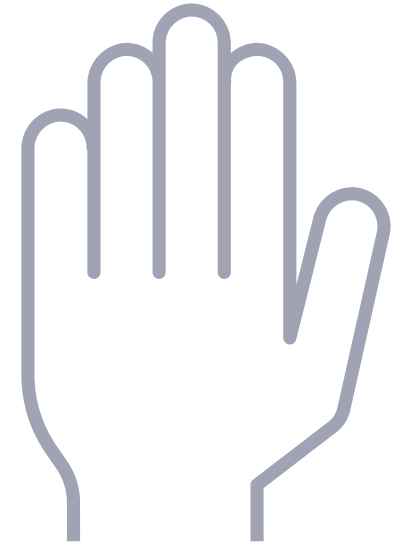
..especially changing behaviours sustainably

3



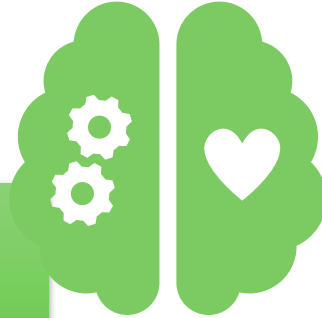
Can you relate to some of these quotes?

- „I cannot convince peers or Pis.“
- „They say they don't have time for this.“
- „This new tool is so cool – why does nobody use it?“
- „We prepared the course so well - and then only a few people showed up.“

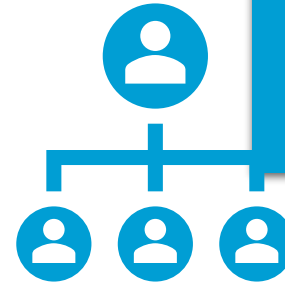


Why is behavior change so hard?

Our brains love the status quo



Goals are often not aligned and there is little management support



Culture reinforces existing behavior



Managing change is a skill that you can learn



Change Management..

1. Focuses on supporting people
2. Aims to achieve specific goals
3. Is a structured process
4. Applies a specific sets of methods and tools
5. Requires time and effort



Change Management is not project management for a change



3 min

Brainstorm: What factors affect the success of a change effort?





10 min

Tell us your examples

- What is a specific change goal you want to achieve in the next months in your basic service project?
- What factors do you think will contribute to success or failure?
- What exactly would you want people to DO?



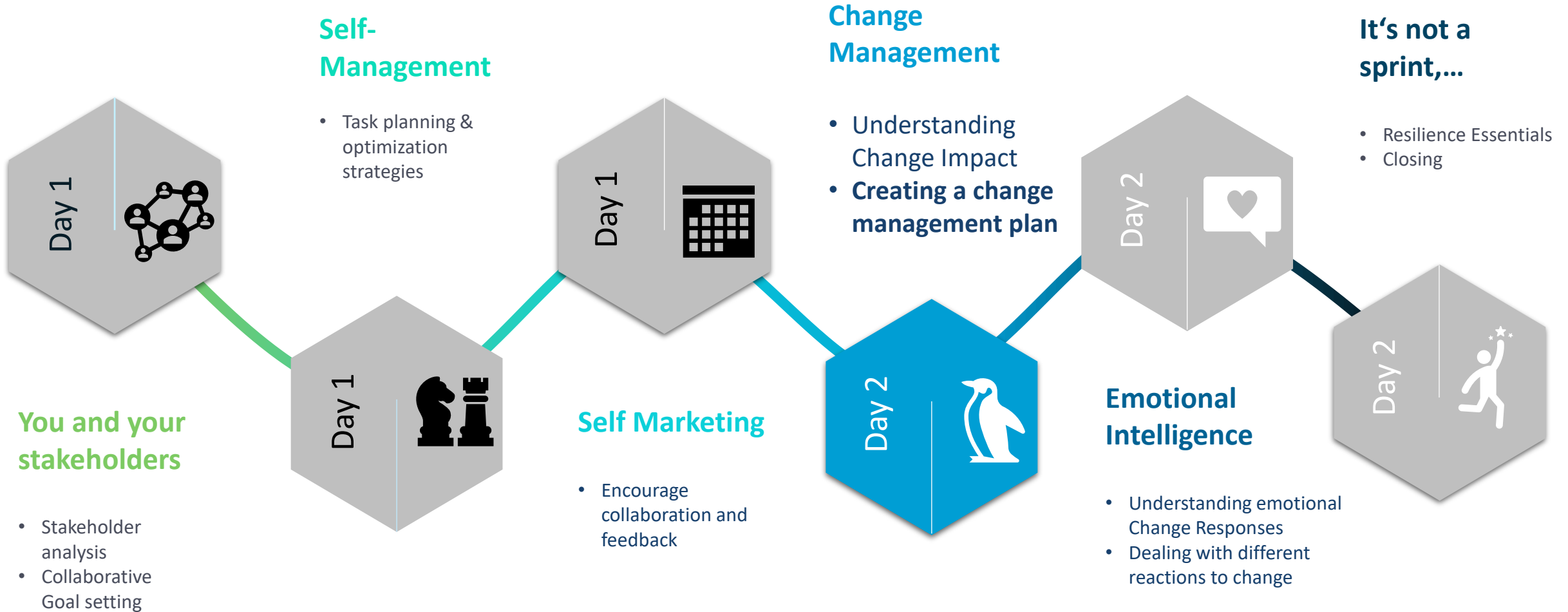
Change Analysis

Teaser



What do you think? WHO needs to understand the WHY and benefits of the change?

Agenda





Our Iceberg is Melting

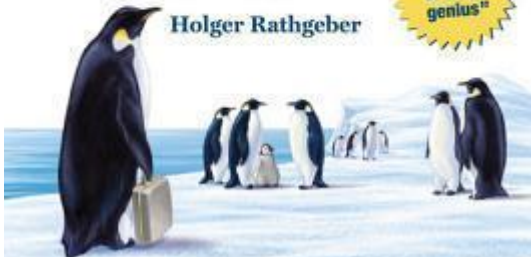
Changing and Succeeding Under Any Conditions

John Kotter

THE AWARD-WINNING AUTHOR
FROM HARVARD BUSINESS SCHOOL

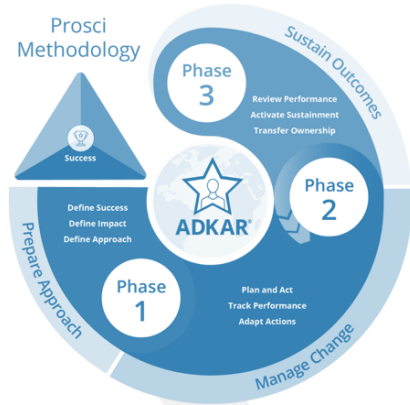
Holger Rathgeber

"...a stroke
of sheer
genius!"



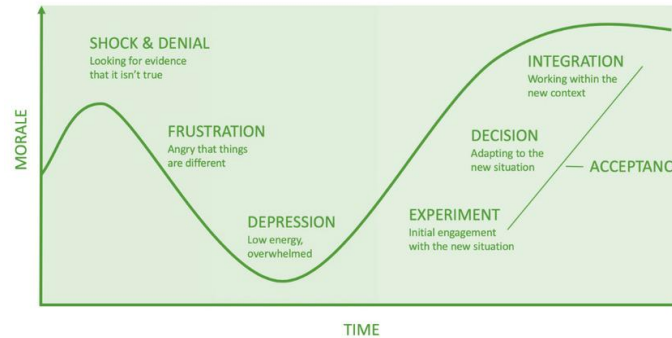
Foreword by Spencer Johnson, M.D., author of *Who Moved My Cheese?*

There are numerous methodologies...



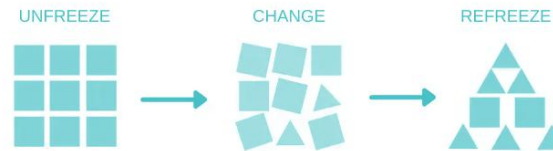
1. Prosci Methodology*

*Antje is certified as a Prosci Change Practitioner



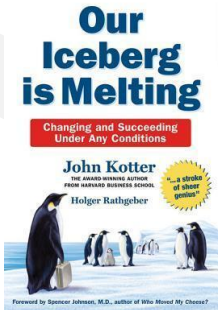
3. Kübler-Ross „Change Curve“

2. Kurt Lewin "CATS": Unfreeze – Change – Refreeze



**too simplistic

4. John Kotter: 8 steps



Images (24.03.2025):

- <https://www.prosci.com/blog/prosci-methodology>
- <https://expertprogrammanagement.com/2021/09/unfreeze-change-refreeze/>
- <https://www.humancapitalbuilders.nl/post/what-is-kubler-ross-change-curve>
- <https://www.kotterinc.com/methodology/8-steps/>

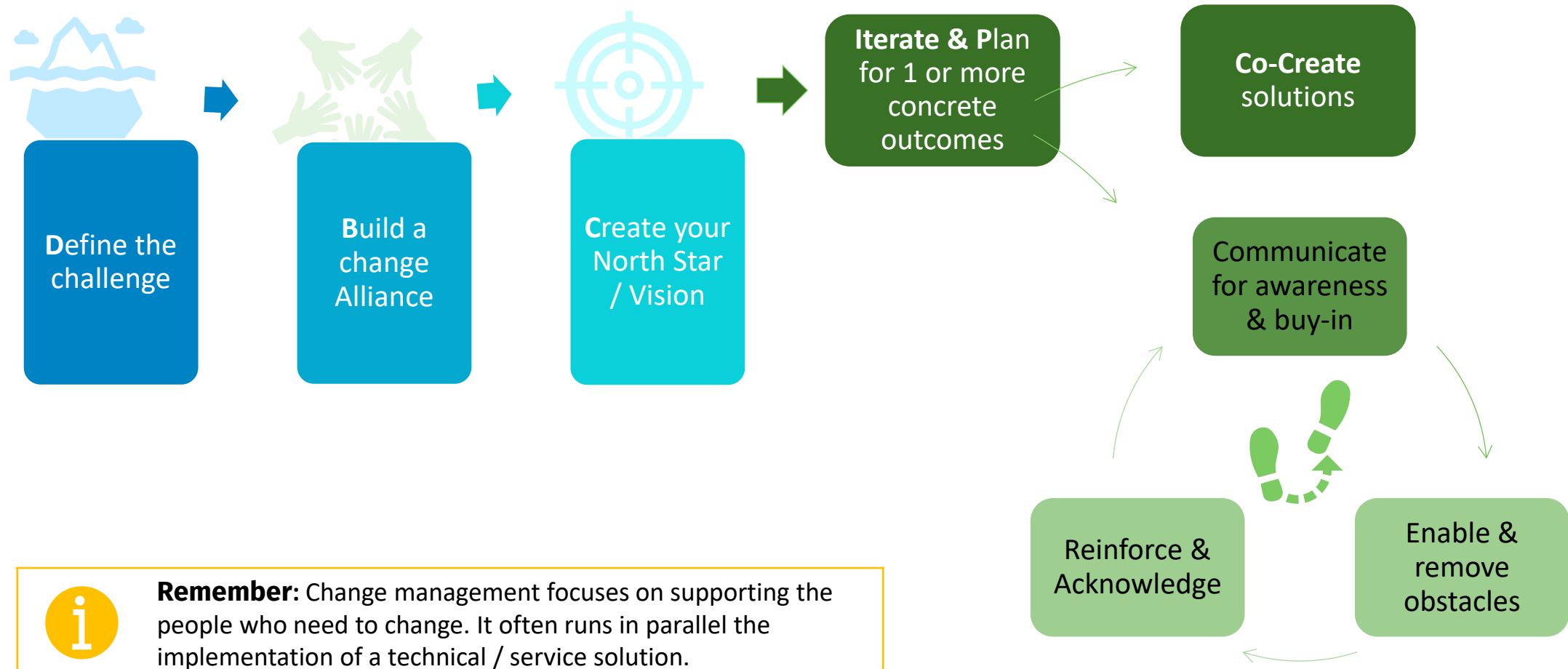
Some early take-aways

1. Give room to temporary fear, frustration & anger
2. THINKING differently can help change behavior but FEELING differently can change behavior more and lead to better results
3. Communicating the „Why“ of the change and what the individual can gain by changing is key BEFORE you start training and enabling people



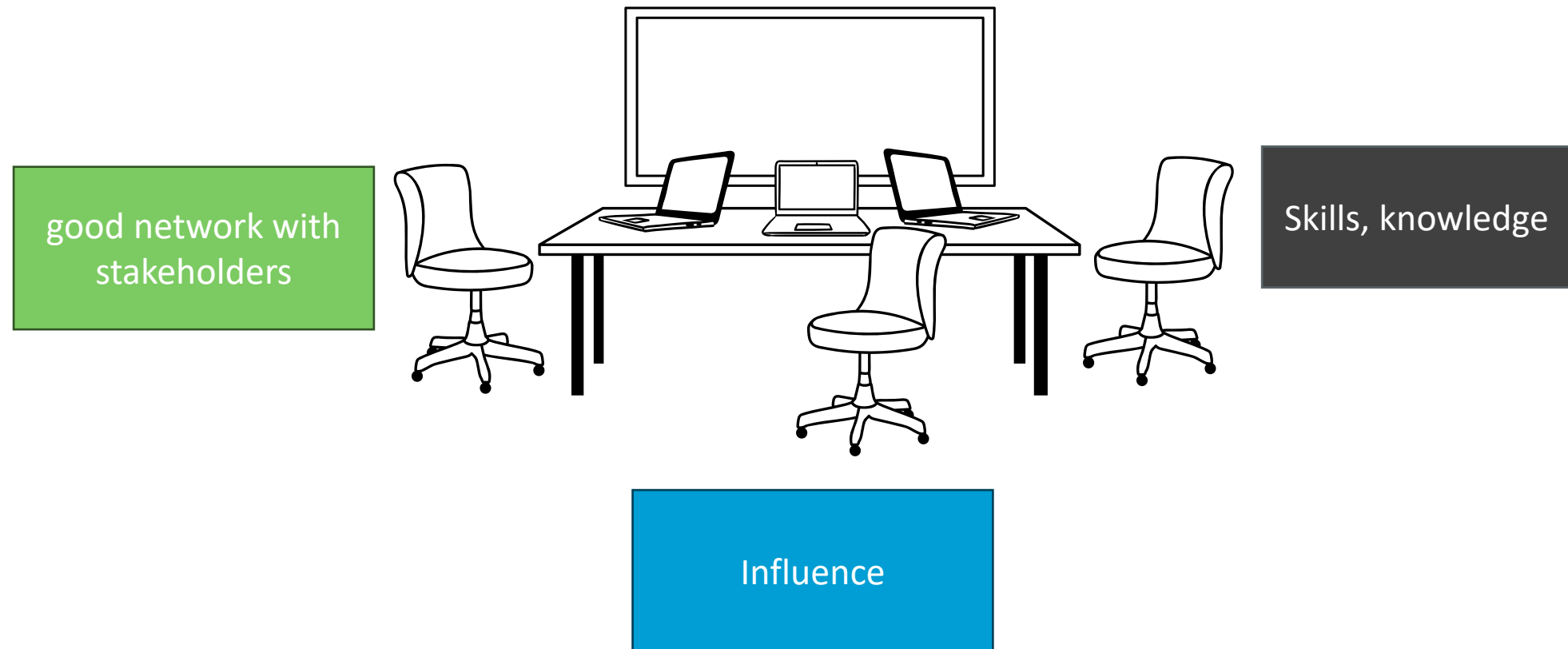
How to do it

A systematic way to approach change



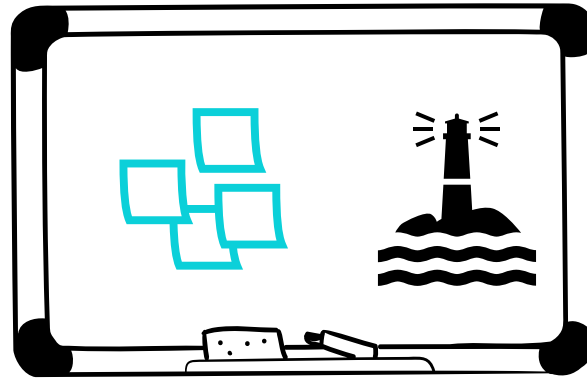
Step 2 - Build an Alliance

You need people with time + ...



Step 3 - Create your Vision

= attractive and
attainable image of the
desired future state

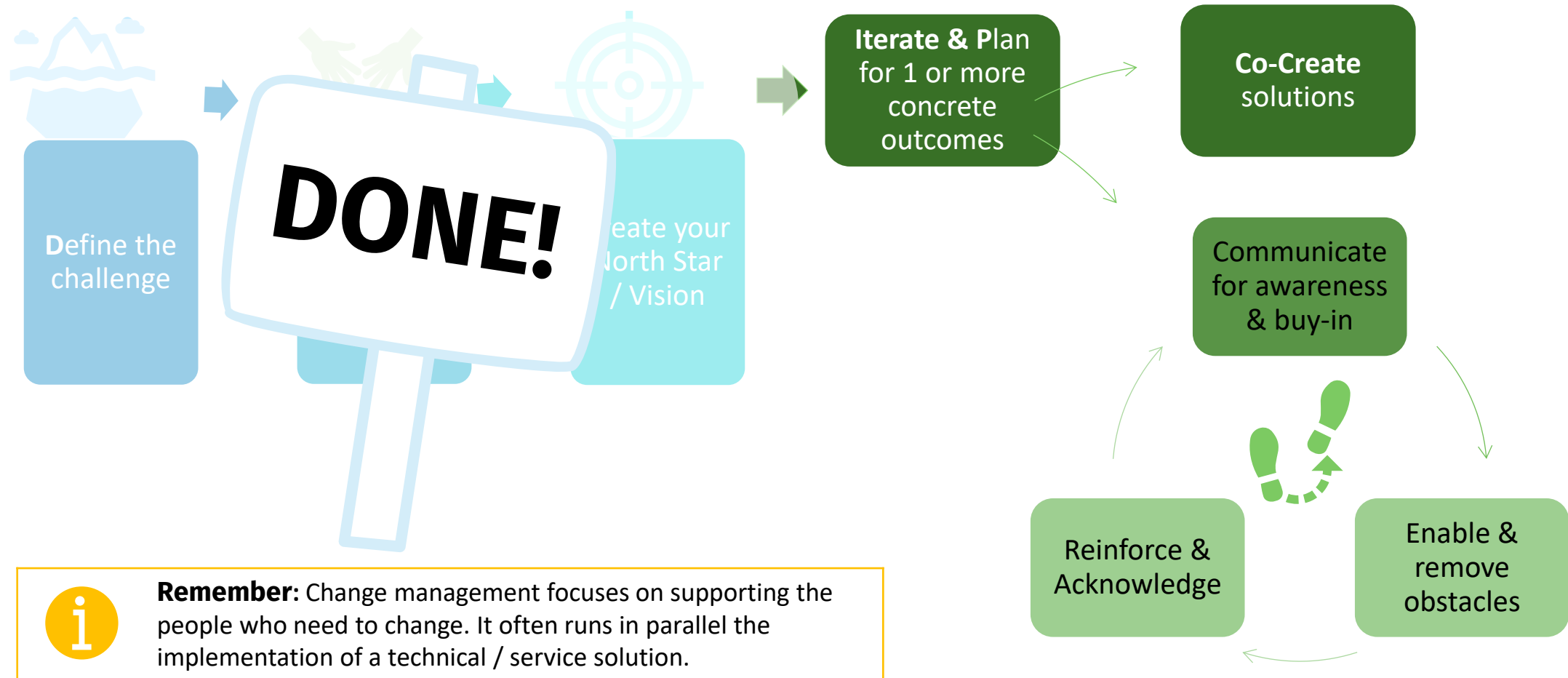


easy to understand

Agreed on with
all relevant
stakeholders

flexible enough to be
interpreted by different
teams and under
changing conditions

A systematic way to approach change



Iteratively: Plan next outcomes

- What is / are the concrete outcomes you want to achieve in the next 2-4 weeks
 - ✓ Target group
 - ✓ Measures (communicate – enable – reinforce)
 - ✓ Check MoSCoW
- “Acceptance criteria”
- Who to involve?



Co-create solutions

Why?

Involves users early → higher buy-in & fit
Reduces resistance → faster adoption

Identify user needs	Early design / selection	Testing and Feedback	Implementation
User Interviews	User Stories	Usability testing	Gradual roll-out
Diary studies	Ideation (Design Thinking, Lego, ...)	Regular user panels	Multipliers as communicators
User Journey mapping	Prioritization of features („Min Specs“)	Co-design	Co-create communication & training
...	...	...	...

Communicate for awareness & commitment

Communication Ideas

- 1-1 communication for individual benefits and doubts – also top-down
- Team Meetings & Townhalls
- Newsletters / Mail
- Internal media / website
- External media (conferences, ..)

How?

Who?

Direct “managers” if it affects daily work

What?

1. Build awareness (Specific Why & What)
2. Communicate benefits for the researcher / PI /.. (WIIFM)
3. Two-way communication, listen actively

Clear & consistent!

Enable and remove obstacles

First check if target group is aware and motivated

Training

- How Tos
- Posters
- Coaching / mentoring
- ...

Support

- Sustain management support
- Office Hours
- Continuous encouragement
- ...

Ambassador Programs

- Train the Trainer
- Train Management / Leadership
- Find champions and trailblazers

Change Experience

- Build prototypes
- Start small
- Create success stories

Reiterate

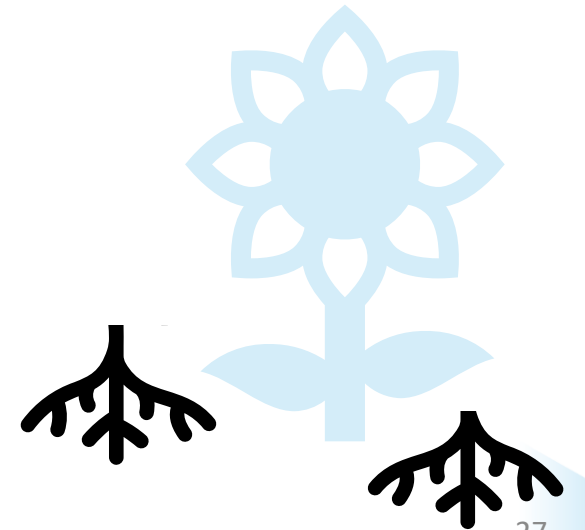
- Get feedback
- Listen actively
- Address barriers & cultural aspects

7 – Reinforce & Acknowledge

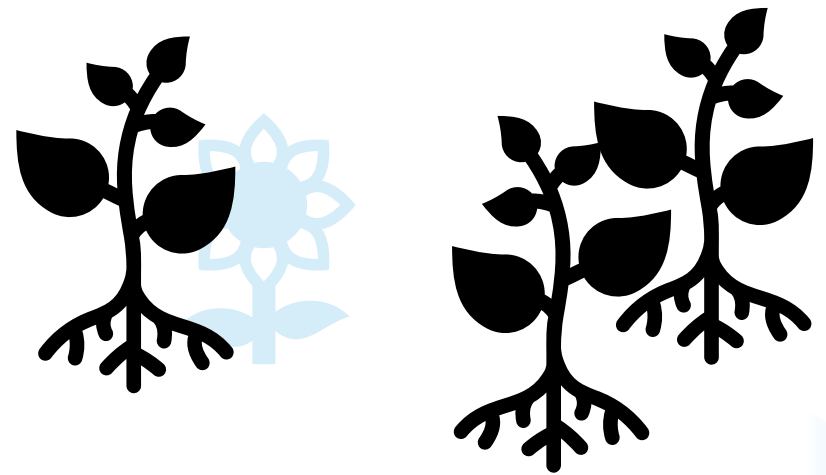
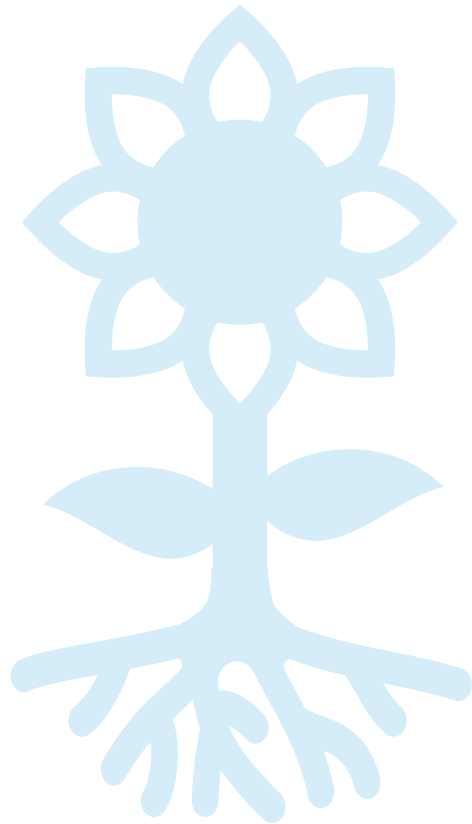
You made people aware, they understood their benefits and you trained them – all good... right?



People seem to adopt the new behavior.. But then...

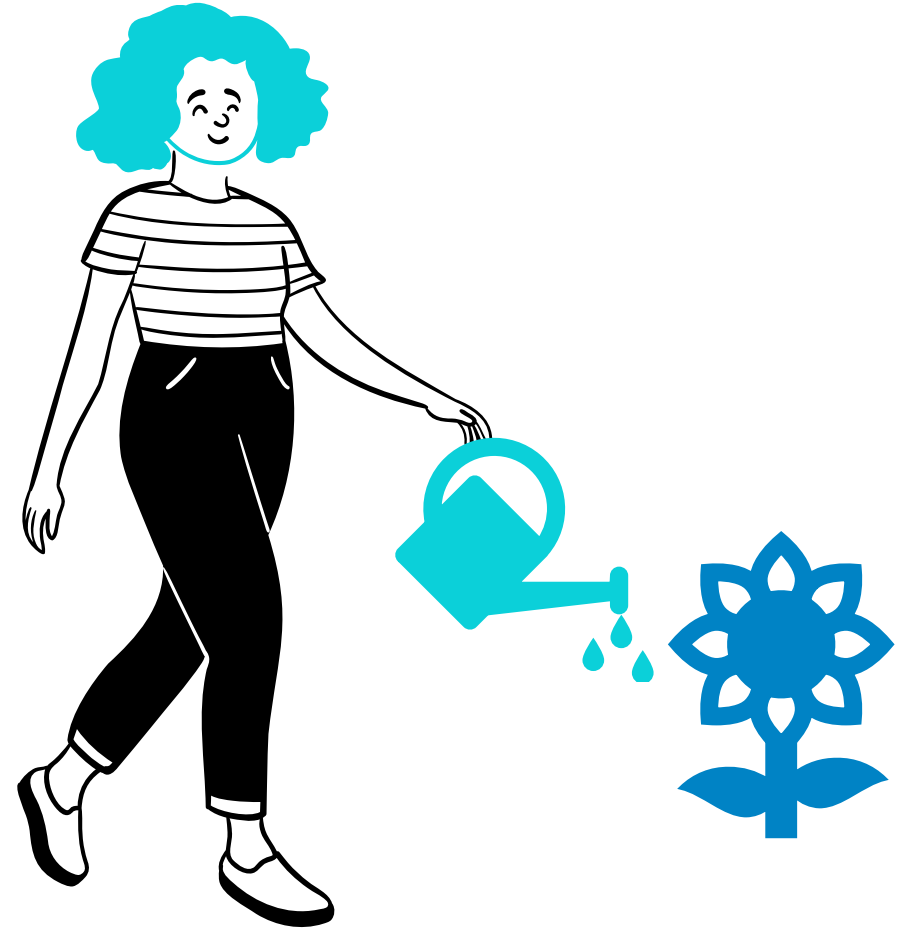


Wish vs. Reality

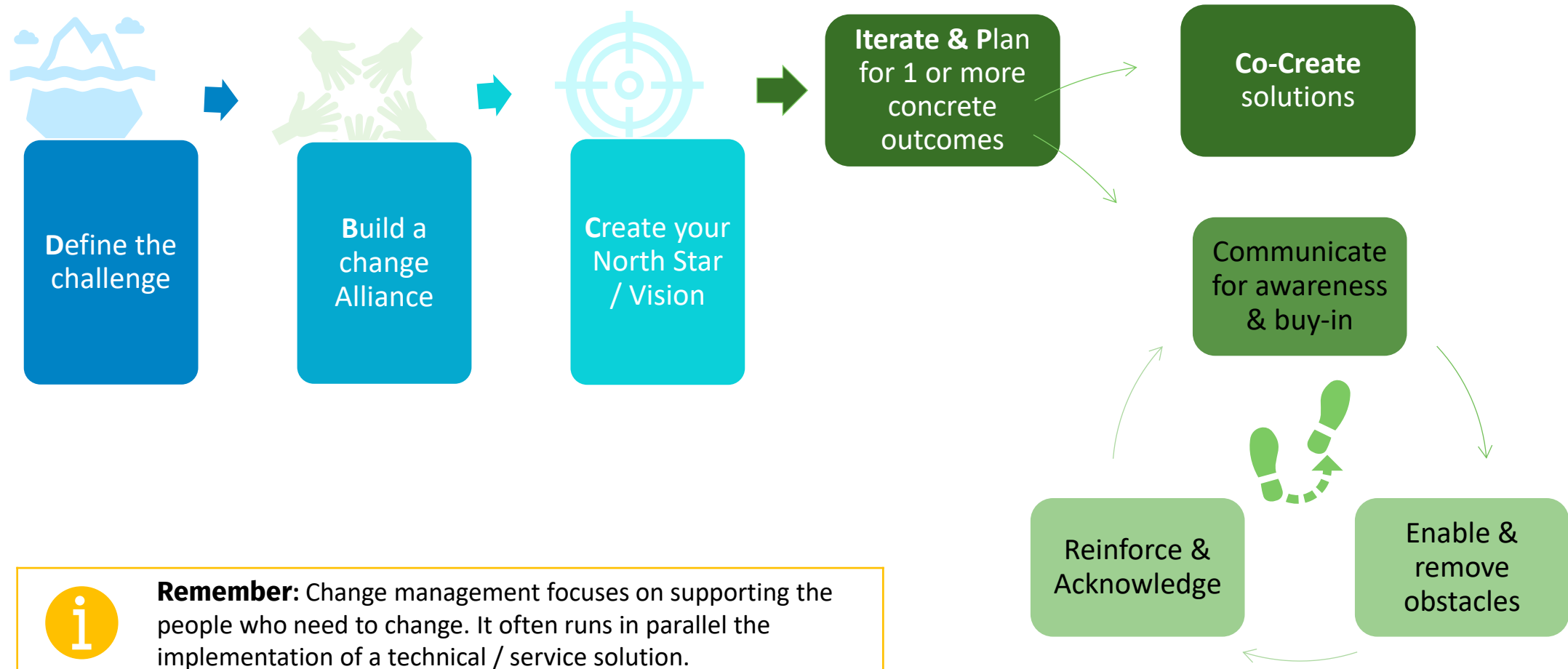


Reinforcement

- Follow up at least twice
 - Repeat messages often and in different ways
- Keep listening
 - For obstacles, objections
 - For success stories
- Celebrate (transitions, good-byes, successes)
 - Acknowledge effort put in
 - Communicate evidence for impact
- Don't let up!



A systematic way to approach change



Recommended Reads

- Kotter, J., & Rathgeber, H. (2017). *Our iceberg is melting*. Macmillan.
- Phillips, J., Klein, J.D. Change Management: From Theory to Practice. *TechTrends* **67**, 189–197 (2023).
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s11528-022-00775-0>
- www.prosci.com
- https://hr.berkeley.edu/sites/default/files/change_management_toolkit.pdf

10 min

Gather first ideas for your change goal

- Who do you need on your change alliance? Also think about representatives of user and multiplier groups
- Where can I offer co-creation for the solutions built?
- How can you build awareness and motivate your target group for the behavior change?
- How can you enable people and remove obstacles?
- How can you celebrate achievements and effort and reinforce behavior?

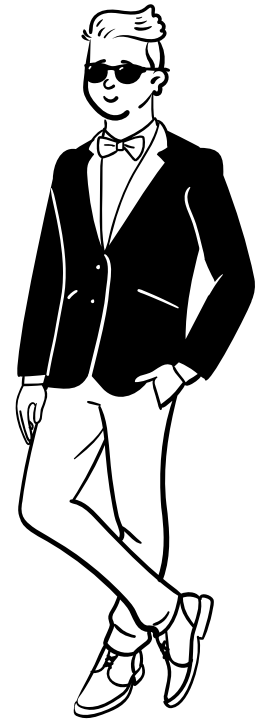
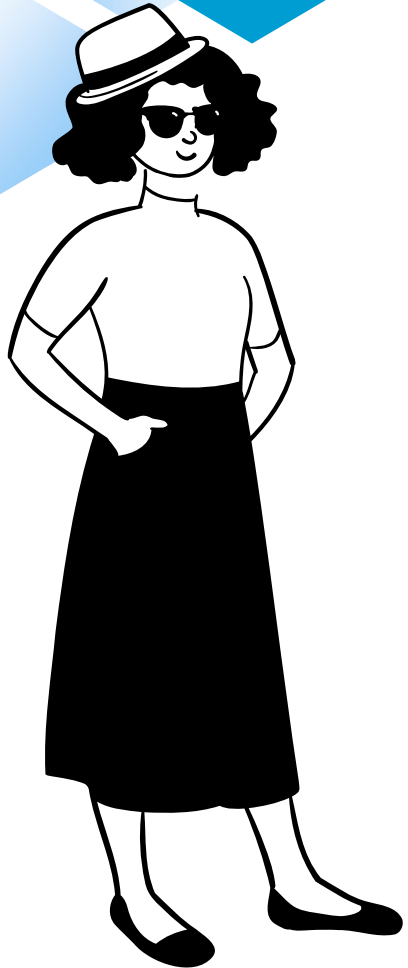




Reflection & Recap

- What are your questions?
- What was a surprising idea you got during this exercise?
- What was difficult?

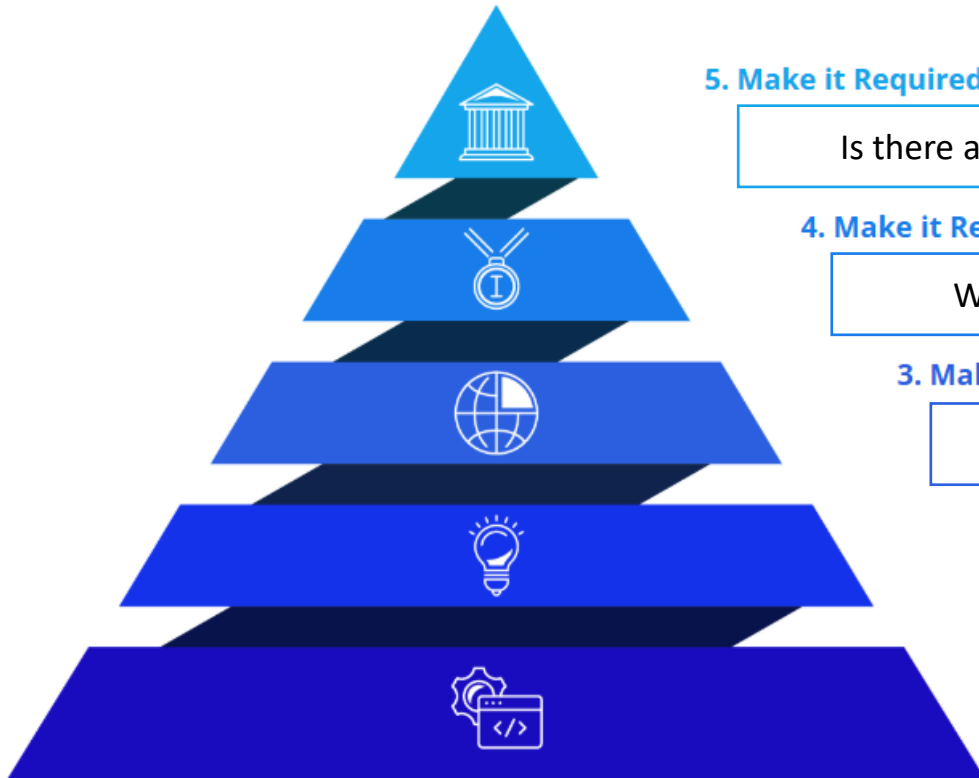




So that's how we change
research culture!

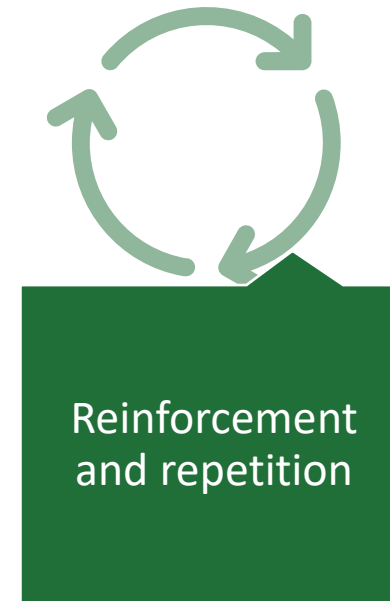
..well yes, and...

Culture Change



<https://www.cos.io/impact>

To summarize, change in research needs...





THANK YOU!